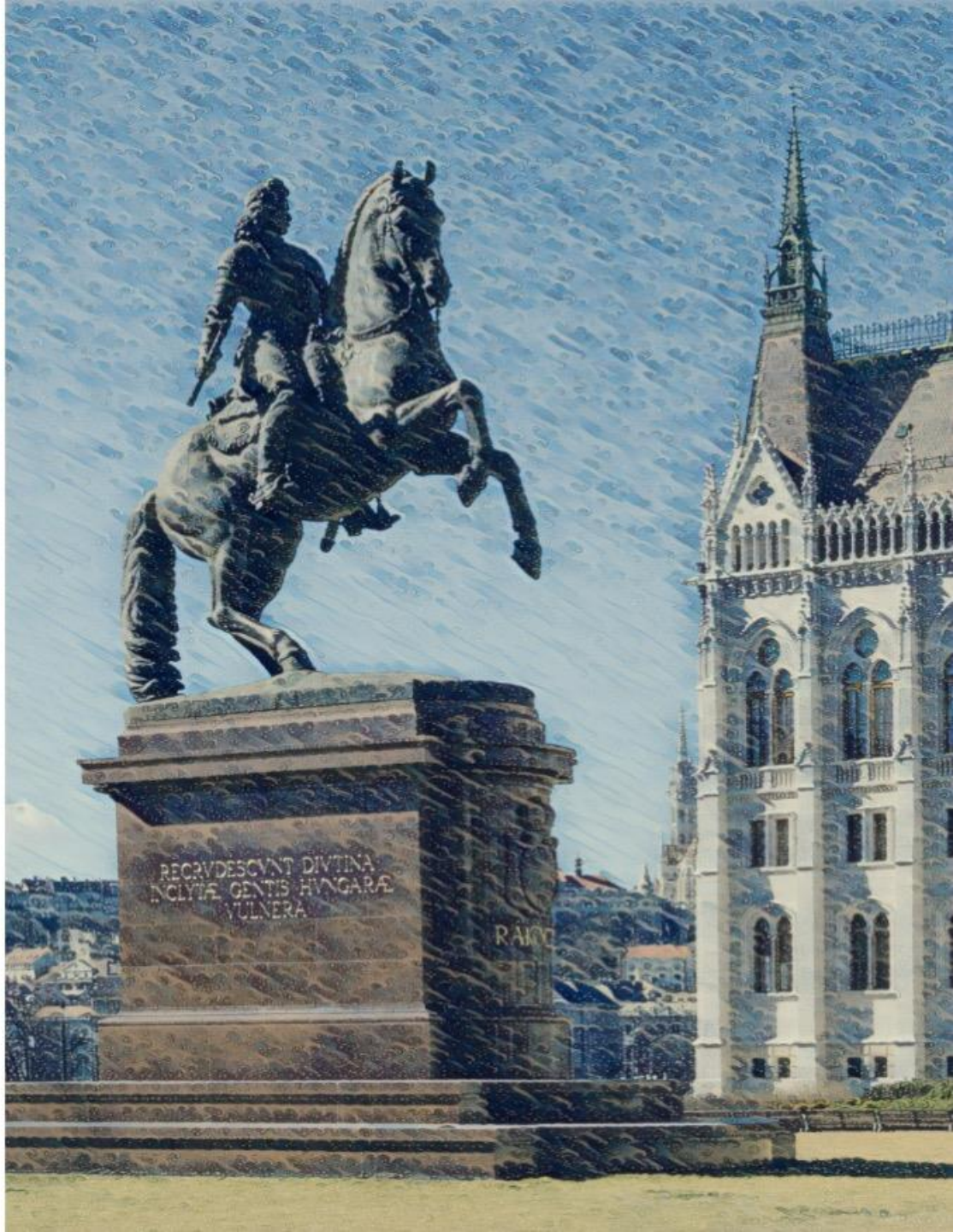
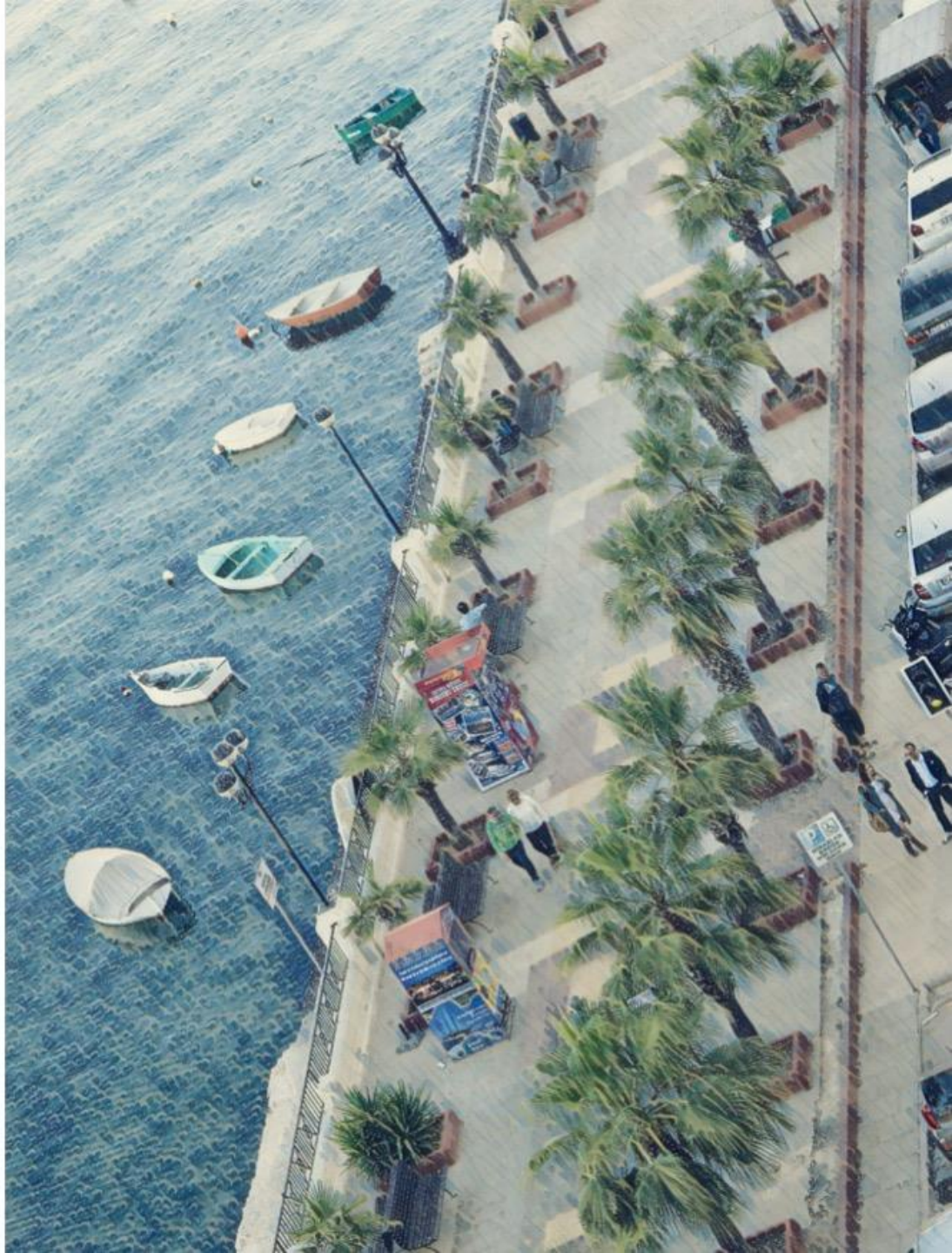
Introduction to Destination Branding

Spring 2026



What is a Destination?

- Country
- Region
- Resort
- Hotel
- More?

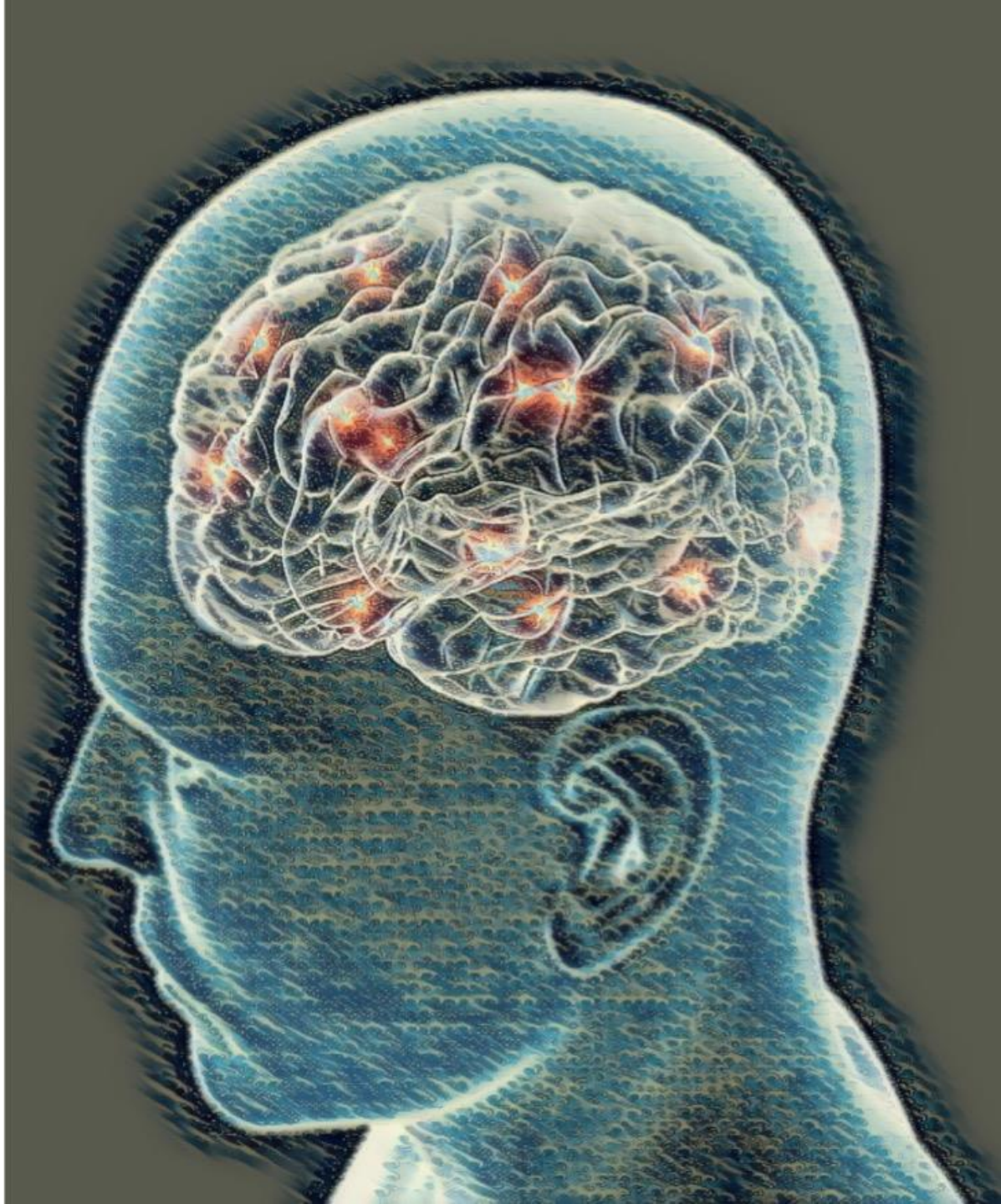


What is a Brand?

- An Aura of Beliefs & Expectations which make a Product (or Service) Relevant & Distinctive

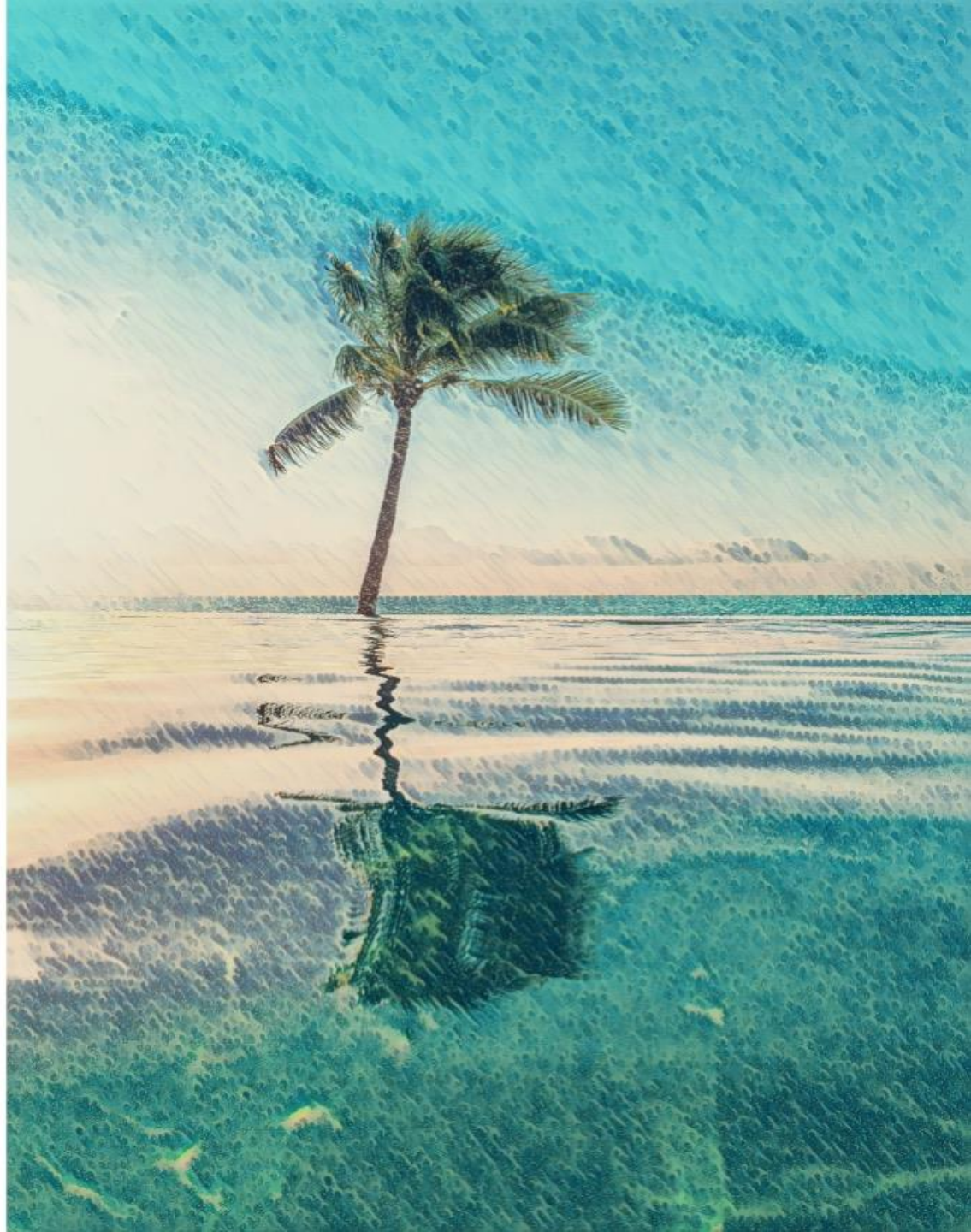
Where do Brands Exist?

- In the Minds of the Customer
- So don't mess with them!



Why Do Destinations Need Brands?

- Targeting
- Differentiation
- Recall



Service Characteristics

- Variability
- Inseparability
- Perishability
- Intangibility

Variability

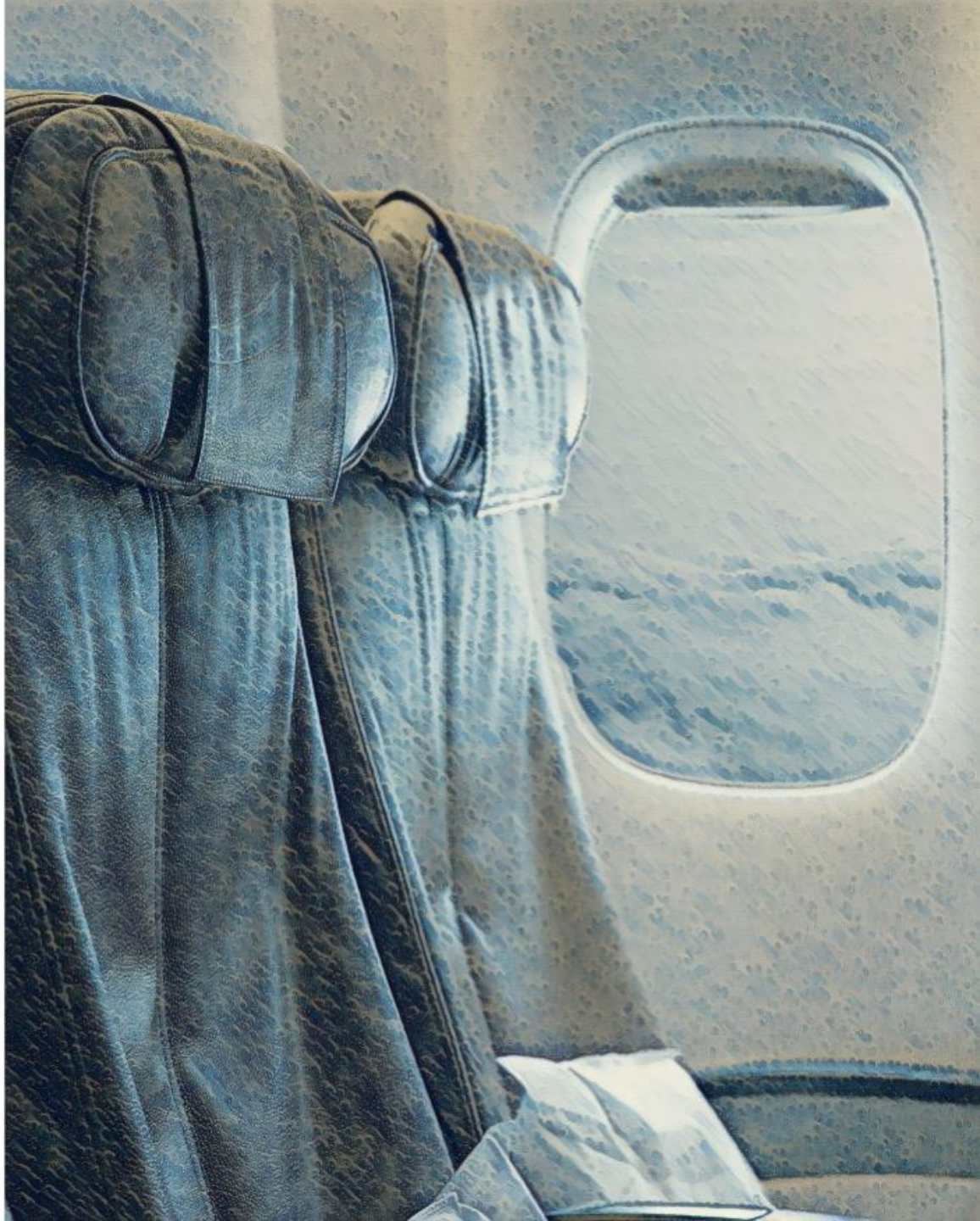
- Services Delivered by People
- Brands keep the Focus
- Internal Identity

Inseparability

- The Guest is part of the Service
- Perceptions will vary
- Targeting Matters

Perishability

- Can't sell Today's Product Tomorrow
- Season Development



Intangibility

- You can't Try before you Buy
- Need to build emotional linkages
- Importance of Association

Six Senses?

- Sight
- Sound
- Smell
- Taste Touch
- The Package

Describe Paris!

- Even if you haven't ever been there…

Describe Fiji!

- How did you build the picture?

Describe Seychelles!

- What's the Difference?
- What's the Risk?